

Shutdown grinds on as neither side budes

Informal talks make little progress on compromise to break the deadlock

BY RILEY BEGGIN, PAUL KANE AND THEODORIC MEYER

The Senate failed again Friday to reopen the federal government, as lawmakers voted down the same funding extensions that they've been considering all week — all but guaranteeing that the shutdown will continue through the weekend, as there won't be more votes until Monday.

White House officials again signaled Friday that layoffs would be coming if the government remains closed, with press secretary Karoline Leavitt warning that the Trump administration was "actively considering" where to cut.

The House — which canceled votes this week to add pressure on Democrats to accept the GOP bill — plans to remain out of session next week as well, leaving no quick avenue for changing the existing proposal.

More than 750,000 federal employees are furloughed, and many others are working without pay, since funding laws expired early Wednesday morning when the new fiscal year began. Many federal agencies have almost entirely halted work, though national security and law enforcement functions are continuing.

On Capitol Hill, preliminary talks continued around how to find a compromise that could break the deadlock. One possible option is a shorter funding extension through Oct. 31, which Democrats say could keep pressure on Republicans to extend

SEE SHUTDOWN ON A6

An Ohio mother's son died of an overdose. She's raising his daughter. And she thinks drug settlement money should help families like hers.



MADDIE MCGARVEY/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Other victims of opioids cry for help

BY MARISA IATI

MARYSVILLE, OHIO — The room was small and she shared a bed with her granddaughter, but after two decades of financial hardship, Jackie Lewis was grateful just to have a roof over her head.

She had drained her retirement funds and sold her home trying to save her son, Shaun, from opioid addiction, pouring money into rehab and lawyers and slipping him \$20 here and there to pay off debts to dealers. When he died of a fentanyl overdose in 2022, his funeral cost \$14,000. Lewis charged it to a credit card.

Now she is raising Shaun's daughter, Avalynn, a spunky 10-year-old who experienced opioid withdrawal as a newborn

Avalynn with her grandmother, Jackie Lewis, before her May dance recital in Marysville, Ohio.

because of exposure to the drug in the womb. Until they moved to Arizona this summer, they stayed in a spare room at Lewis's brother's house, living off Social Security payments that are enough to disqualify Lewis from food stamps but too little to pay for a house of her own.

The family's hardship belies the gusher of money flooding the country in response to the opioid epidemic. Roughly \$57 billion is set to flow to state and local governments from legal settlements with drug manufacturers, distributors and pharmacy chains

alleged to have funneled addictive pills to every corner of the United States. Ohio alone will receive roughly \$1.8 billion.

Officials plan to use the funds to prevent more deaths through addiction treatment programs, prevention efforts and naloxone to reverse overdoses.

But almost three decades after the opioid crisis began, evolving from abuse of prescription drugs into an epidemic of heroin and fentanyl use, families like Lewis's say they also have a claim on those resources. Roughly 80,000 people in the United States were killed by drugs last year, with synthetic opioids usually involved. In the decade preceding 2021, more than 320,000 children lost a parent to an overdose, according

SEE OPIOIDS ON A4

Spanberger holds wide lead in Va. governor race

Poll shows Democrat has picked up independents, voters worried about jobs

BY GREGORY S. SCHNEIDER, ERIN COX, SCOTT CLEMENT AND EMILY GUSKIN

RICHMOND — Democrat Abigail Spanberger leads Republican Winsome Earle-Sears by double digits in the contest for governor, according to a Washington Post-Schar School poll of Virginia voters, picking up strong support from independent voters as well as those who are worried about the state's job market. But the races are much closer for lieutenant governor and attorney general, where Democratic nominees who tack harder to the left see thinner support from swing voters.

Spanberger, a former congresswoman, leads Earle-Sears, the state's lieutenant governor, by 12 percentage points, 55 percent to 43 percent, among Virginia's likely voters in the Nov. 4 election. Spanberger holds a similar 13-point lead among registered voters overall, who say the economy is by far the most important issue

SEE POLL ON A14

Combs gets 4 years for prostitution-related charges

BY ANNE BRANIGIN, SAMANTHA CHERY, AMBER FERGUSON AND SHAYNA JACOBS

NEW YORK — Sean "Diddy" Combs was sentenced Friday to just over four years in prison, after a lengthy hearing during which Combs apologized to the ex-girlfriends who had accused him of sex trafficking, as well as years of emotional and physical abuse.

'I hate myself right now,' hip-hop mogul says in presentence apology

In stern words delivered directly to Combs, Judge Arun Subramanian told the hip-hop impresario that he had abused ex-girlfriends Cassie Ventura and a

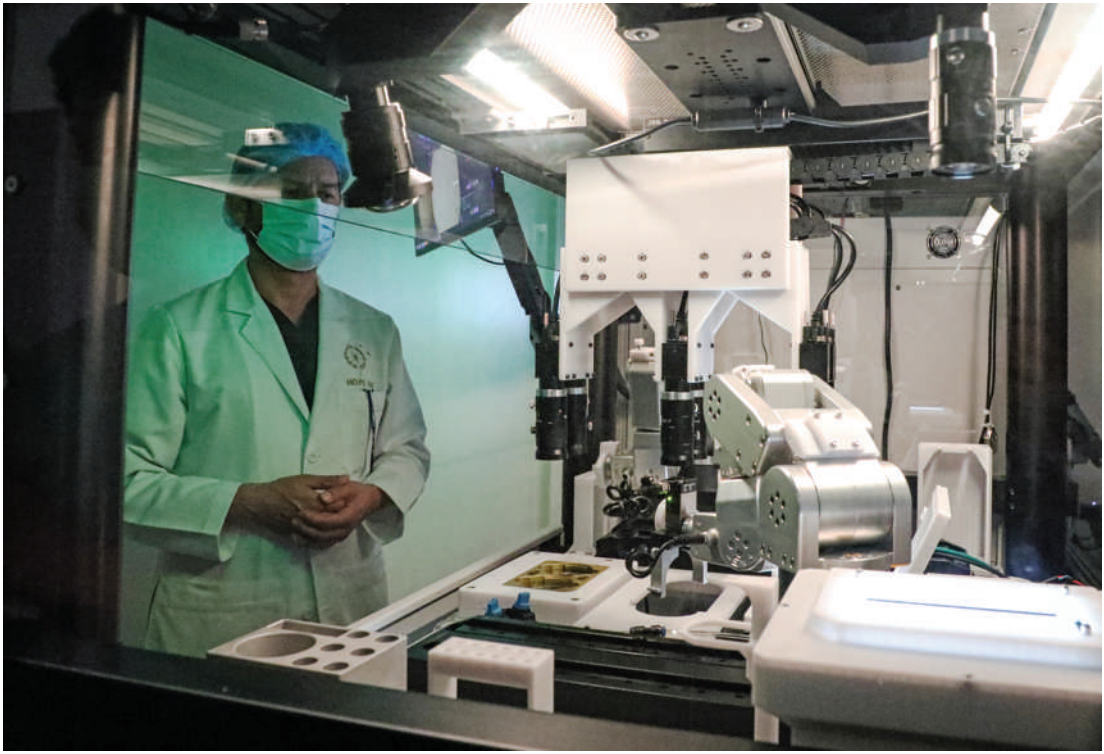
woman who had testified under the court-approved alias Jane "physically, emotionally and psychologically."

Subramanian delivered Combs's 50-month sentence after a nearly two-month sex abuse and racketeering trial that ended in July. The jury had cleared Combs of the most serious charges but convicted him on two counts of transportation to engage in prostitution, under the Mann Act.

He also ordered Combs to pay a \$500,000 fine and imposed five years of supervised release once the music producer completes his sentence.

The sentence was above the 14 months Combs's defense had requested, but 20 months below what the presentencing report had recommended. The judge said he considered mitigating factors presented by the defense

SEE SENTENCING ON A11



ZOEANN MURPHY/THE WASHINGTON POST

Alejandro Chávez-Badiola with the Aura automated system at his IVF clinic in Mexico City.

In IVF labs, robots are making babies

Doctors say AI could expand access, success

BY ELIZABETH DWOSKIN AND ZOEANN MURPHY

MEXICO CITY — When she walked into an IVF clinic in June, Alin Quintana knew it would be the last time she would try to conceive a child. She had prepared herself spiritually and mentally for the visit: She had traveled to a nearby state to leave prayer ribbons at a shrine dedicated to Mary Undoer of Knots, a manifestation beloved in Latin America. She had received a blessing from her priest. That morning, as Quintana and her husband wound their way for hours from the unpaved outskirts of the Mexican capital toward the swanky clinic in one

of its richest neighborhoods, her mind was alert, as if she were making a recording. She was focusing on the moment, she said, to drown out the weight of painful memories — a lost pregnancy, a burst fallopian tube, emergency surgery, 96 monthly cycles of hope and crushing disappointment.

But now she was ready to be part of a generational experiment: A robot would create her baby.

Chatbots have invaded our conversations and self-driving cars roam our streets, but the creation of life is a new frontier for artificial intelligence. In-vitro fertilization has produced more

SEE FERTILITY ON A12

IN THE NEWS

Virginia attorney general race Democratic nominee Jerrauld "Jay" Jones sent private texts that used violent language in relation to other political figures, images show. B13

Manchester synagogue attack As authorities continue to investigate a motive, they say one of the victims was fatally shot by police. A10

THE NATION **Bari Weiss**, a critic of the mainstream media, will be named CBS News's top editor. A2
For the first time, an American was crowned "Best Cheesemonger in the World." A3

THE WORLD **Charlie Kirk's** death has become a rallying point for South Korea's far right. A9
The U.S. killed four alleged drug smugglers near Venezuela, the defense chief said. A11

THE ECONOMY **Apple** removed an app from its store that tracks ICE activity after a request from the Justice Department. A8
ChatGPT's new parental controls are easily circumvented, leaving teens still at risk of potential harms, Geoffrey Fowler writes. A15

STYLE **Taylor Swift's** new "The Life of a Showgirl" wants to feel good, but other emotions keep getting in the way. B1

SPORTS **The MLB playoffs** enjoyed a first-round renaissance, and among the things we learned is that power still plays. B7

THE REGION **A Californian** who plotted to kill Supreme Court Justice Brett M. Kavanaugh received an eight-year sentence. B13
Maryland is set to announce a \$340 million deal to reduce pollution from the Conowingo Dam along the Susquehanna River. B13

BUSINESS NEWS.....A15
COMICS.....B4
OBITUARIES.....B15
OPINION PAGES.....A16
TELEVISION.....B6
WORLD NEWS.....A9

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